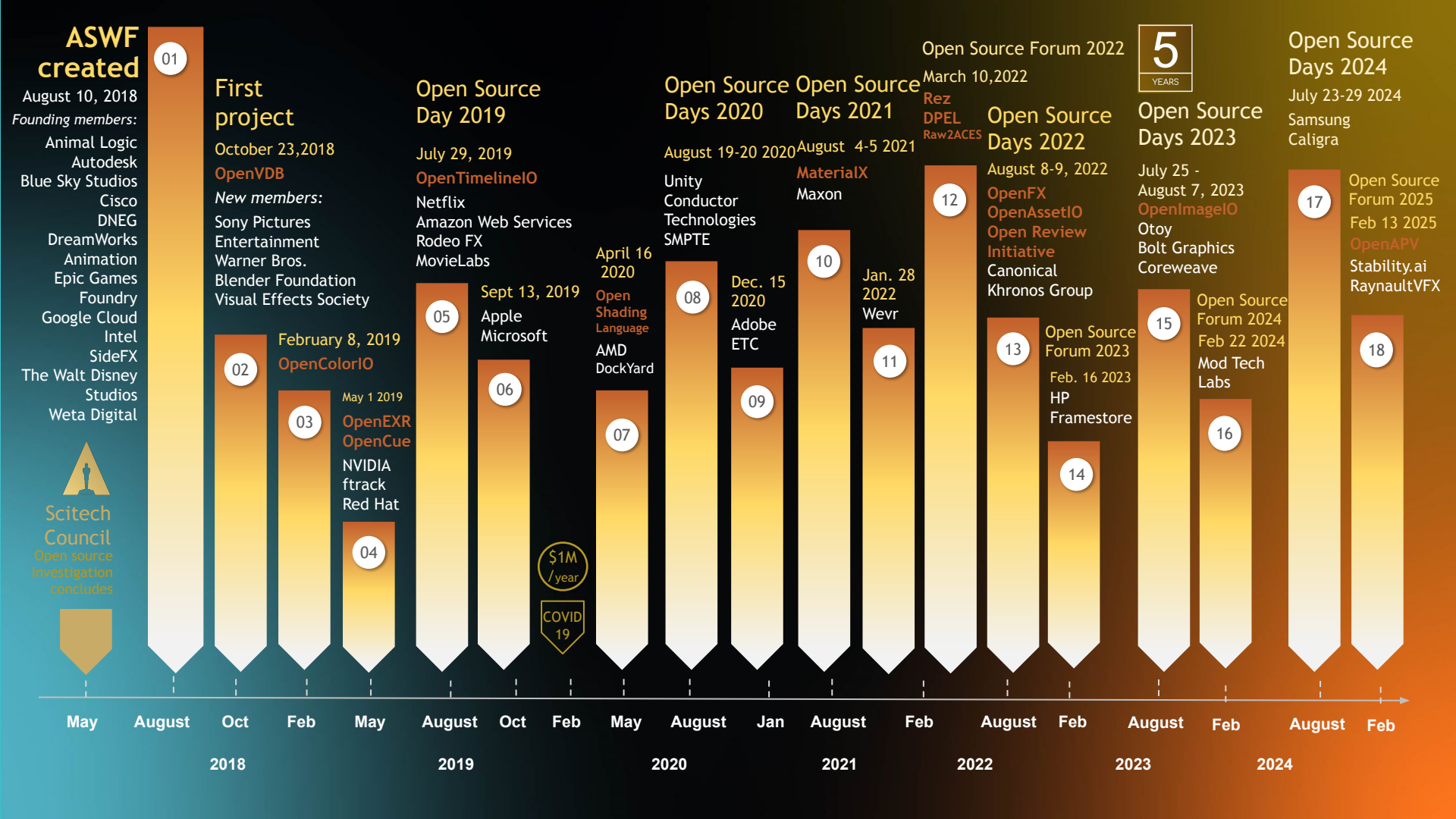
/* ACADEMY SOFTWARE FOUNDATION

Governing Board Overview

Academy Software Foundation Overview and Governance

An Open Source Foundation Developed in Partnership

The Academy Software Foundation provides a neutral forum for open source software developers in the motion picture and broader media industries to share resources and collaborate on technologies for image creation, visual effects, animation and sound.


ASWF created
August 10, 2018
Founding members:
Animal Logic
Autodesk
Blue Sky Studios
Cisco
DNEG
DreamWorks Animation
Epic Games
Foundry
Google Cloud
Intel
SideFX
The Walt Disney Studios
Weta Digital
Scitech Council
Open source investigation concludes
01
First project
October 23,2018
OpenVDB
New members:
Sony Pictures Entertainment
Warner Bros.
Blender Foundation
Visual Effects Society
02
February 8, 2019
OpenColorIO
03
May 1 2019
OpenEXR
OpenCue
NVIDIA
ftrack
Red Hat
04
Open Source Day 2019
July 29, 2019
OpenTimelineIO
Netflix
Amazon Web Services
Rodeo FX
MovieLabs
05
Sept 13, 2019
Apple
Microsoft
06
$1M /year
COVID 19
April 16 2020
Open Shading Language
AMD
DockYard
07
Open Source Days 2020
August 19-20 2020
Unity
Conductor Technologies
SMPTE
08
Dec. 15 2020
Adobe
ETC
09
Open Source Days 2021
August 4-5 2021
MaterialX
Maxon
10
Jan. 28 2022
Wevr
11
Open Source Forum 2022
March 10,2022
Rez
DPEL
Raw2ACES
12
Open Source Days 2022
August 8-9, 2022
OpenFX
OpenAssetIO
Open Review Initiative
Canonical
Khronos Group
13
Open Source Forum 2023
Feb. 16 2023
HP
Framestore
14
5 YEARS
Open Source Days 2023
July 25 - August 7, 2023
OpenImageIO
Otoy
Bolt Graphics
Coreweave
15
Open Source Forum 2024
Feb 22 2024
Mod Tech Labs
16
Open Source Days 2024
July 23-29 2024
Samsung
Caligra
17
Open Source Forum 2025
Feb 13 2025
OpenAPV
Stability.ai
RaynaultVFX
18
May
August
Oct
Feb
May
August
Oct
Feb
May
August
Jan
August
Feb
August
Feb
August
Feb
August
Feb
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024

Membership

Premier

Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences
Adobe
AMD
aws
AUTODESK
DNEG
DreamWorks
Epic Games
intel
LAIKA
Microsoft
NETFLIX
NVIDIA
SAMSUNG
SKYDANCE ANIMATION
Sony Pictures imageworks
Walt Disney Studios
weta FX

General

BOLT GRAPHICS
caligra
Canonical
CoreWeave
FRAMESTORE
ftrack
hp
MAXON
NETFLIX ANIMATION STUDIOS
otoy
Raynault VISUAL EFFECTS
Red Hat
SideFX
stability.ai
FOUNDRY
WB

Associate

blender
etc
movie labs
SMPTE
KHRONOS
VES

We're a nonprofit, but not separately incorporated

- The Academy Software Foundation is part of the the Linux Foundation and is not a separate legal entity
- Therefore, the Academy Software Foundation Governing Board is not a corporate board of directors, and is not subject to corporate law statutes (e.g., those that govern fiduciary duties and how corporate boards of directors must operate)
- The powers and duties of the Governing Board are set forth in the Academy Software Foundation Charter

Academy Software Foundation

Structure

TAC
Technical Advisory Council

Governing Board

Outreach Committee

ACES
RMTC
DNA
OpenAEV
OpenImageIO
OPEN REVIEW INITIATIVE
OPENASSETIO
DPEL
OpenFX

rez
rawtoaces
MATERIALX
open shading language
OpenEXR
OpenTimelineIO
OpenCue
OpenColorIO
OpenVDB

Continuous Integration platform

Key Governing Bodies and Committees

- Business & Marketing Leadership
  - Governing Board (Governing Board)
    - Budget Committee
    - Legal Committee
  - Outreach Committee
- Technical Leadership
  - Technical Advisory Council (TAC)
    - You can review the TAC meeting information and upcoming schedule and join the mailing list
  - Hosted Projects and Working Groups

Governing Board Responsibilities

Governing Board Responsibilities

The Governing Board's responsibilities include:

- Approving the Academy Software Foundation budget, directing the use of funds to advance the mission of the Academy Software Foundation;
- Directing marketing and outreach efforts;
- Providing financial governance overall;
- Voting on other decisions that come before the Governing Board.

Additional responsibilities are described in Section 3 of the Academy Software Foundation Charter.

What the Governing Board is NOT responsible for

- The Governing Board does **not** make technical decisions for Academy Software Foundation other than working with the TAC to set the overall scope for the Academy Software Foundation.
- The Governing Board is **not** responsible for overseeing day-to-day operations of Academy Software Foundation. This is the responsibility of the foundation staff.
- The Governing Board is **not** a Board of Directors; it is a committee that provides budget oversight and direction. There are no personal liabilities for individual Governing Board representatives.

Governing Board Operations

Governing Board Composition

- The Governing Board voting members consist of:
  - One representative appointed from each Premier member; and
  - General member elected representatives (if any)
  - The TAC Chairperson
- See Section 3(a) of the Academy Software Foundation Charter for more information about composition.

ACADEMY SOFTWARE FOUNDATION

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Governing Board Representatives

Rob Bredow
Chair
Industrial Light & Magic

Carol Payne
TAC Representative
Individual - No Account

Daniel Heckenberg
Netflix, Inc.

Darin Grant
Treasurer
General Member Representative
Netflix

Eric Bourque
Vice Chair
Autodesk

Eric Mejdrich
Advanced Micro Devices (AMD)

Greg Brentin
Skydance Animation, LLC

Gregory Ducatel
Sony Pictures Entertainment

Guido Quaroni
Adobe Inc.

Guy Martin
NVIDIA Corporation

Jeff Stringer
LAIKA, LLC

Jeremy Smith
General Member Representative
HP Inc.

Kimball Thurston
Wētā FX Limited

Kwang Pyo Choi
Samsung Electronics Co. Ltd.

Lincoln Wallen
General Member Representative
Individual - No Account

Mark Jackels
DreamWorks Animation

Meredith Shea
Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences

Michael B. Johnson
Apple Inc.

Paul Salvini
DNEG

Sean McDuffee
Intel Corporation

Sean Wallitsch
Amazon Web Services, Inc.

Sebastien Miglio
Epic Games, Inc

Simon Crownshaw
Microsoft Corporation

Governing Board Representative Characteristics

- Knowledgeable / has experience in technology and open source in the media and entertainment industry
- Has a point of view on the industry's future
- Is a strategic thinker
- Has previous board experience as a plus, but not necessary
- Is results-driven
- Is an effective communicator
- Is respectful of other points of view
- Is an influential and empowered decision-maker within their own organization
- Is able to create an environment within their organization for developing future ASWF leaders
- Is able to develop a Governing Board member pipeline within their own organization
- Has demonstrated willingness to contribute, to participate in board/committee activities
- Will advocate for the ASWF within their organization
- Is committed to make the ASWF as an organization and as a community more diverse

Alternates Policy

- Premier and General member companies with appointed representatives on the Governing Board may appoint alternates.
- Alternates may attend all Governing Board meetings.
  - If the primary representative is present, the alternate may participate in listen-only mode and may not vote or speak.
  - Only if the primary representative is unable to attend the meeting, the alternate may speak and vote in lieu of the primary representative.
- At Strategy and Leadership Meetings (at which no voting occurs), both primary and alternate representatives may speak (the alternate does not need to participate in listen-only mode)

ACTION: To appoint your representative and your alternate, please file a request at members.aswf.io, and have the representatives create an LF ID.

You can change your representative at any time by making a request at members.aswf.io.

Governing Board Alternates

Alexander Wilkie
Netflix

Beverley Kite
Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences

Bhanu Srikanth
Netflix, Inc.

Cary Phillips
Industrial Light & Magic

Duncan Burbidge
Epic Games, Inc

Erik Niemeyer
Intel Corporation

Greg Denton
Microsoft Corporation

john canning
Advanced Micro Devices (AMD)

Jonathan Gerber
LAIKA, LLC

Keith Stichweh
Skydance Animation, LLC

Kevin Sprout
NVIDIA Corporation

Larry Gritz
Sony Pictures Imageworks

Morgan Prygrocki
Adobe Inc.

Paul DiLorenzo
DreamWorks Animation

Rachel Rose
Industrial Light & Magic

Scott Cler
Amazon Web Services, Inc.

Tony Micilotta
Autodesk

Youngkwon Lim
Samsung Electronics Co. Ltd.

Succession Policy

- Maximum term for any Governing Board representative is 4 years.
  - Individuals may serve again on the Governing Board after a two year break between terms.
  - Individual may serve as an alternate during the two year break.
  - There are no lifetime term limits.
- Governing Board target goal of rotating 25% of Governing Board representatives on an annual basis.
  - If there are less that 25% of new representatives, the Governing Board may request longer tenured representatives to appoint a replacement.

Governing Board Chairperson

Annually in January, the Governing Board will elect a chairperson to serve for the current year.

Duties of the Governing Board Chairperson include:

- Oversee the day-to-day operational decisions of the Academy Software Foundation.
- Work with the foundation staff to prepare the agenda for Governing Board meetings.
- Be a spokesperson for the Academy Software Foundation and the Governing Board, as needed

See Section 3(c) of the Academy Software Foundation Charter for more information about the chairperson role.

Governing Board Treasurer

Annually in January, the Governing Board will elect a treasurer to serve for the current year.

Duties of the Governing Board Treasurer include:

- Serve as the chairperson of the Budget Committee
- Work with the foundation staff to prepare financial updates and reforecasts to the Budget Committee and Governing Board.
- Work with the foundation staff in preparing and leading the approval of the annual budget.

See Section 3(c) of the Academy Software Foundation Charter for more information about the treasurer role.

Governing Board Meetings

Meeting Cadence

- The Governing Board has monthly virtual regular meetings, generally on the fourth Thursday of each month.
- Format for the meetings alternates between a formal business meeting and strategy session
  - At the formal business meetings, voting will often take place.
  - For the strategy meetings, the Governing Board will align on a topic to discuss at the previous business meeting.
- Additionally, the Governing Board has two hybrid Leadership Meetings sessions per year (at Open Source Forum in February and Open Source Days in August).
  - TAC voting members and a representative from each General Member are invited to Strategy Sessions.
- In rare and exceptional circumstances (e.g., in an emergency situation), an additional ad hoc special meeting of the Governing Board may be convened.
  - To request a special meeting, please email your request to the Foundation Staff and Governing Board Chair, and they will decide whether a special meeting is necessary or the proposed agenda item can be discussed by email or at the next regular meeting.

FY2026

Meeting Schedule

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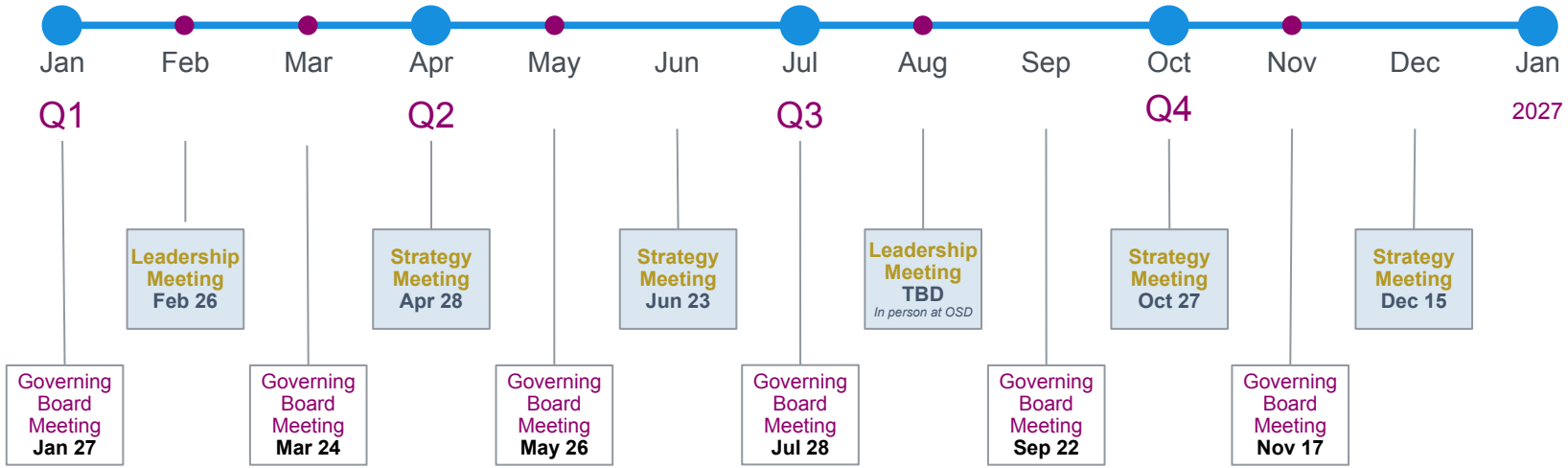

Future Meetings of the Governing Board for 2026 will be held at 1:00 pm US Pacific Time unless noted

How to propose an agenda item

- If you would like to propose an agenda item for discussion at a Governing Board meeting, please submit your proposal to the Academy Software Foundation Executive Director & the Governing Board Chair.
- Please include in your request:
  - A description of the topic
  - Board resolution or discussion-only item
  - Requested amount of time to discuss the item
- For a regular Governing Board meeting, please submit your proposed agenda item at least 10 days prior to the meeting.
- For a Strategy Session, please submit your proposed agenda item at least 30 days prior to the meeting.

Proposing an agenda item (continued)

- Please be patient. Our board meeting agendas are often very full. If we cannot accommodate your request in the upcoming meeting we may:
  - Wait until the following meeting to discuss the topic
  - Call a special meeting to discuss your topic, or
  - Refer the topic to the appropriate committee or task force of the Governing Board.
- We may ask you to provide slides 5 days before the meeting, and slides are subject to change (with your approval) to fit the broader meeting slide deck.

Governing Board Materials

- Agendas and Exhibits for Governing Board meetings will be made available one week prior to the scheduled meeting
  - The FINAL deck will be made available one day prior to the meeting.
- Past meeting materials can be found here.
- All meeting materials are confidential and for the view of Governing Board representatives and their alternates ONLY, unless otherwise specified.
  - No meeting of the Governing Board is recorded unless the Governing Board provides explicit consent to do so.

Discussion Channels

Relevant Mailing Lists

- Governing Board: board@lists.aswf.io
- TAC: tac@lists.aswf.io
- Budget Committee: budget@lists.aswf.io
- Legal Committee: legal@lists.aswf.io

Slack Channel

- You can join Academy Software Foundation slack here.
- To join the Governing Board slack channel, make a request at members.aswf.io.

Governing Board Committees

Budget Committee

- The Budget Committee is lead by the Governing Board Treasurer and collaborates with the Academy Software Foundation staff to develop and review the Academy Software Foundation budget.
- Any Governing Board representative may join (not alternates)
- Meets generally monthly on the Monday of the week before the Governing Board meeting

ACTION: If you want to participate in the Budget Committee, make a request at members.aswf.io.

Legal Committee

- The Legal Committee makes recommendations to the Governing Board regarding license exception requests from Academy Software Foundation projects and other questions submitted to the Legal Committee by the Governing Board.
- The Legal Committee does not represent Academy Software Foundation and does not have an attorney-client relationship with Academy Software Foundation.
- Meets on an as needed basis.
- Governing Boards may attend only if accompanied by their legal counsel.

Policies and Other Resources

Important Academy Software Foundation Policies and Resources

- Academy Software Foundation Charter
- Linux Foundation Antitrust Policy
- Foundation GitHub repository with many other public facing policies and materials including…
  - Elections Process
  - Academy Software Foundation hosted project charters, which define each project's intellectual property and licensing policies.
- ASWF Landscape
- High Level Overview

LFX Organization Dashboard

LFX Organization Dashboard provides access to key membership materials, including…

- Member contacts, which you can change at any time (look under ‘Users’ > and then under the ‘Key People’ tab)
- Membership details (look under ‘Membership’ > ‘Academy Software Foundation’), including…
  - Membership Overview Deck and High Level Overview Deck (look under the ‘Resources’ tab)
  - Your fully executed membership agreement (look under the ‘Membership’ tab)
  - Details on how to leverage membership benefits (look under the ‘Benefits’ tab)
  - Insights on contributors from your organization (look under the ‘Project Contributors’ tab)

ACTION: Request access to LFX Organizational Dashboard here.

Foundation Staff

David Morin
Executive Director

Emily Olin
Director of Marketing Communications

Emily Ruf
Event Director

John Mertic
Director of Program Management

Yarille Ortiz
Senior Project Coordinator

Contact the staff at members.aswf.io

Who's Who in the Academy Software Foundation

- Academy Software Foundation Members
- Staff: Academy Software Foundation Staff, Linux Foundation Leadership
- Governing Board Members
- Technical Advisory Council Members
- Academy Software Foundation Project and Working Group Leads

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Thank you!

If you have any questions, feel free to contact the staff at members.aswf.io.